

# TB Shimmer

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## Overview

**Expands sound into pitch-shifted particles and a long, bright, floating space.**

### What this plug-in solves

Conventional delay and reverb can add depth, but they do not automatically create the rising, reverse-blooming, particle-like motion associated with granular shimmer. Building that result from separate pitch, delay, feedback, filtering, diffusion, and randomization plug-ins is slow and difficult to recall. TB Shimmer combines those stages in one deterministic effect for pads, keys, guitar, vocals, percussion, loops, and sound-design sources while preserving a direct dry path.

### What you can expect

- Pitch-rising or falling granular clouds without changing clip duration
- Distinct particles that can bloom into a smooth evolving stereo wash
- Independent control of grain timing, size, density, reversal, and three kinds of random variation
- Diffuse early reflections and a long filtered late tail with repeatable host recall

## How it works

TB Shimmer reads short overlapping pieces from the recent input, moves their pitch, and spreads them into a cloud. Reverse, timing variation, and pitch variation keep the particles from behaving like one obvious copy, while the original source can remain direct through Mix.

The particle cloud then passes into early diffusion and a longer spacious tail. Feedback keeps feeding energy back into the texture, Tone controls how much brightness survives, and Width sets the final spread. Establish Time, Size, Density, and Pitch first; add randomness next; raise Feedback only after the basic cloud is stable.

## Quick start

- 1 Start from Init and set Mix to 100 percent temporarily so the wet structure is clear.
- 2 Set Pitch to +12 semitones for classic shimmer or choose another interval.
- 3 Balance Time, Size, and Density until the grain rhythm or smoothness fits the source.
- 4 Add Scatter, Reverse, Level Var, Position Rand, and Pitch Spray one at a time.

- 5** Raise Feedback only after the basic cloud is stable, then use Tone to control accumulated brightness.
- 6** Set Width and return Mix to the required insert or aux balance while checking mono compatibility and output headroom.

# Interface and key sections



This is a direct capture of the current plug-in interface. Use the visible labels to locate the areas and controls explained below.

## Time

Sets how far back each particle reads from the recent sound history. Short settings stay close to the source; long settings separate the cloud from the attack without delaying the dry path.

## Size

Sets the length of each sound particle. Short particles feel rhythmic and detailed; long particles overlap into smoother tones and also make the surrounding tail feel larger.

## Density

Sets how often new sound particles appear. Low density leaves audible events and gaps; high density builds a continuous cloud and feeds the surrounding reverb more strongly.

## Scatter

Varies grain size and stereo pan, and drives deterministic smooth-random motion in the diffuse tail. It controls spatial and temporal dispersion without replacing the dedicated Level Var, Position Rand, or Pitch Spray controls.

## Pitch

Sets the base transposition of the sound particles. An octave above creates the classic shimmer, lower settings create descending clouds, and the neutral position preserves the source pitch before Pitch Spray is applied.

## Reverse

Sets the probability that an individual grain plays backward. Low values add occasional inhaling motion; high values turn attacks into reverse blooms while the direct dry path remains available through Mix.

## Feedback

Returns the filtered granular signal to history and independently lengthens the late diffuse tail, with a target decay up to about 45 seconds. High values accumulate pitch and energy, so raise it gradually and monitor the tail after transport stops.

## Tone

Sets the upper tonal limit of the particle path and damps the long reverb tail. Lower settings darken accumulated feedback; higher settings preserve sparkle.

## Width

Sets the width of the combined particle and diffuse wet signal, moving from mono-compatible narrowing to deliberate widening. Recheck phase and mono compatibility whenever the sound is widened.

## Mix

Blends the direct dry path with the complete particle, early-diffused, and long-tail signal. Use a fully wet setting on an aux return and a smaller blend on an insert.

## Level Var

Randomly lowers individual sound particles without boosting them above the base level. Higher settings create a less uniform particle field and more depth.

## Position Rand

Randomizes each particle's read position around the Time setting. Use it to loosen repeated timing without changing the overall delay center.

## Pitch Spray

Adds independent upward and downward pitch variation around the Pitch setting. Small values create chorused instability; large values create atonal or cluster-like clouds.

## **Bypass**

Uses a softened bypass transition. Bypass removes the processed result for comparison; allow long tails to finish before removing the plug-in or closing the session.

## **Programs and state**

Program provides a large factory collection across utility, diffuse, sparkle, random, pulse, vocal, guitar, keys, pads, dark, and experimental groups. User presets and DAW sessions preserve all controls.

## Controllable properties

The guide uses the names shown on the plug-in panel. Each explanation describes the audible result, a useful way to approach the control, and an important interaction to listen for.

| Control              | What it does and when to use it                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bypass</b>        | Turns the complete effect off or on for a direct before-and-after comparison. Compare with bypass at a similar loudness. If the effect creates a tail, let that tail settle before judging the difference.                    |
| <b>Density</b>       | Sets how many particles are created each second. Start with a small amount, then increase it until the motion is clear without hiding the timing or identity of the original sound.                                           |
| <b>Feedback</b>      | Returns the effect into itself to build a longer and more intense tail. Increase it slowly and watch the output level. If the sound keeps growing after the input stops, reduce this control before adding more processing.   |
| <b>Level Var</b>     | Varies particle level so the cloud feels less flat and more layered. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.                          |
| <b>Mix</b>           | Blends the original sound with the processed sound. Turn the processed sound up temporarily to learn its character, then return to the mix and keep only the amount that supports the source.                                 |
| <b>Pitch</b>         | Sets the main pitch interval of the shimmer particles. Choose the musical direction first, then check attacks and sustained notes for unwanted wobble or a change in character.                                               |
| <b>Pitch Spray</b>   | Adds small or large pitch differences between individual particles. Choose the musical direction first, then check attacks and sustained notes for unwanted wobble or a change in character.                                  |
| <b>Position Rand</b> | Varies where each particle begins around the Time setting. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.                                    |
| <b>Program</b>       | Loads a factory starting point. Adjust the controls afterward to fit the current sound. Use a preset as a direction, not a finished answer. Change one section at a time so it is clear which adjustment improves the source. |

| Control        | What it does and when to use it                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Reverse</b> | Sets how often particles play backward and bloom into the sound. Start with a small amount, then increase it until the motion is clear without hiding the timing or identity of the original sound.                                  |
| <b>Scatter</b> | Spreads particle timing, size, and stereo position for a less uniform cloud. Start with a small amount, then increase it until the motion is clear without hiding the timing or identity of the original sound.                      |
| <b>Size</b>    | Sets the length of each particle. Short values sound detailed; long values blend into a smooth wash. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere. |
| <b>Time</b>    | Sets how far behind the dry sound the particle cloud begins. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.                                         |
| <b>Tone</b>    | Darkens or brightens the particles and the long tail. Sweep broadly to find the useful tonal area, then make the focus narrower and the change smaller while listening in the full mix.                                              |
| <b>Width</b>   | Sets the stereo spread of the processed sound. Check the result on speakers, headphones, and in mono when possible. Extreme spatial settings can feel exciting but may not translate everywhere.                                     |

# Practical uses

## Vocal halo

- Set Pitch between +7 and +12 semitones.
- Use medium Size and Density with modest Scatter.
- Keep Reverse, Position Rand, and Pitch Spray low.
- Darken Tone if sibilance builds and use moderate Feedback.
- Blend at a conservative Mix or place fully wet on an aux.

Expected result: The vocal keeps intelligible attacks while a soft ascending halo blooms around phrase endings.

## Pad nebula

- Use long Time and Size with high Density.
- Set Pitch to +12 or +19 semitones.
- Increase Scatter, Position Rand, and Width.
- Use medium Pitch Spray and Level Var for internal motion.
- Raise Feedback for a long evolving tail and lower Tone if the cloud becomes brittle.

Expected result: Sustained harmony expands into a broad prismatic cloud that continues evolving between notes.

## Reverse guitar bloom

- Use medium Time and Size.
- Raise Reverse strongly while keeping Density moderate.
- Set Pitch to +12 and add a little Pitch Spray.
- Use moderate Feedback and automate Mix into phrase endings.

Expected result: Picked attacks remain in the dry path while reversed octave particles swell behind them.

## Percussive dust

- Use short Size, short-to-medium Time, and low Density.
- Keep Feedback low.
- Increase Scatter, Level Var, and Position Rand.
- Use a small Pitch Spray and reduce Mix.

Expected result: The groove gains scattered stereo particles without turning into a continuous reverb wash.



## Common pitfalls

High Feedback, bright Tone, upward Pitch, and dense grains can build energy quickly; lower Mix or Feedback and leave headroom. Reduce the main amount, feedback, drive, or input first, then rebuild the sound while watching the output meter and listening after the source stops.

The late tail can remain audible for a long time after input stops; print or export beyond the last source event. Return the strongest control toward neutral, compare with bypass at a similar loudness, and add the processing back one section at a time.

Extreme Width may reduce mono compatibility, while dense long grains can soften transients and rhythmic definition. Reduce width or movement and check the result in mono as well as stereo. Preserve the original spatial cues when they are important to the recording.

PULSE programs use free-running time values; the plug-in does not claim tempo synchronization or MIDI scale quantization. Feed the plug-in one clear note at a time, confirm the musical key or target, and reduce correction or variation if the result becomes unstable.